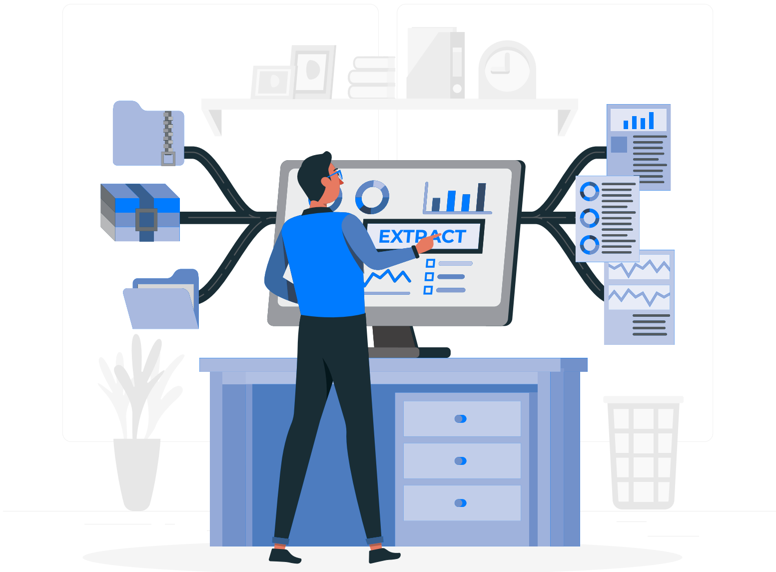
R Series: Text Mining (tm)

In this twenty-first article in the R series, we will learn more about the Text Mining (tm) package, a framework that offers R functions to process documents as well as handle text and data formats.



Text Mining (tm) is a popular package that is useful in machine learning and natural language processing algorithms. We shall explore the various functions provided by the tm package in this article. We will use version 4.2.2 installed on Parabola GNU/Linux-libre (x86-64) for the code snippets.

```
$ R --version
R version 4.2.2 (2022-10-31) -- "Innocent and Trusting"
Copyright (C) 2022 The R Foundation for Statistical Computing
Platform: x86_64-pc-linux-gnu (64-bit)

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https://www.gnu.org/licenses/.
```

You can install and load the tm package using the following commands:

```
> install.packages('tm')
Installing package into '/home/shakthi/R/x86_64-pc-linux-gnu-library/4.1'
...
also installing the dependencies 'NLP', 'slam'
...

 ** testing if installed package can be loaded from final location
 ** testing if installed package keeps a record of temporary installation path
 * DONE (tm)

> library(tm)

Loading required package: NLP
```

getReaders

The *getReaders()* function lists the available functions to extract content from various data sources, as shown below:

```
> getReaders()
 [1] "readDataframe"           "readDOC"
 [3] "readPDF"                 "readPlain"
 [5] "readRCV1"                "readRCV1asPlain"
 [7] "readReut21578XML"        "readReut21578XMLasPlain"
 [9] "readTagged"              "readXML"
```